We have discussed a lot of reasons to run your workloads on AWS. But what does AWS cost? You will learn more about the pricing models in the next section.

1.4 How much does it cost?

A bill from AWS is similar to an electric bill. Services are billed based on use. You pay for the time a virtual machine was running, the used storage from the object store, or the number of running load balancers. Services are invoiced on a monthly basis. The pricing for each service is publicly available; if you want to calculate the monthly cost of a planned setup, you can use the AWS Pricing Calculator (https://calculator.aws/).

1.4.1 Free Tier

You can use some AWS services for free within the first 12 months of signing up. The idea behind the Free Tier is to enable you to experiment with AWS and get some experience using its services. Here is a taste of what's included in the Free Tier:

- 750 hours (roughly a month) of a small virtual machine running Linux or Windows. This means you can run one virtual machine for a whole month, or you can run 750 virtual machines for one hour.
- 750 hours (or roughly a month) of a classic or application load balancer.
- Object store with 5 GB of storage.